

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
LAHONTAN REGION

BOARD ORDER NO. 6-97-95
WDID NO. 6B360100001

REVISED WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS

FOR

BAKER COMMUNITY SERVICES DISTRICT
WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY

San Bernardino County

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Lahontan Region (Regional Board) finds:

1. Discharger

Baker Community Services District submitted a complete revised Report of Waste Discharge for the Baker Wastewater Treatment Facility on July 31, 1997. For the purposes of this Regional Board Order (Order), the Baker Community Services District is referred to as the "Discharger."

2. Facility

For the purposes of this Order, the Baker Wastewater Treatment Facility is referred to as the "Facility." The Facility discharges domestic wastewater.

3. Order History

The Regional Board previously established Waste Discharge Requirements (WDRs) for the Facility under Board Order No. 6-79-55, which were adopted on October 11, 1979. Revised WDRs were subsequently adopted on October 13, 1994.

4. Reason for Action

Since the adoption of Board Order No. 6-94-101, the Discharger has constructed a fifth evaporation/percolation pond. This Order recognizes the increase from four to five ponds and revises the design capacity of the ponds from a seasonal range between 0.23 to 0.40 million gallons per day (mgd) to a seasonal range between 0.35 to 0.52 mgd.

5. Facility Location

The Facility is located about 0.5 miles south of the Community of Baker, near the intersection of Kelbaker Road and Interstate 15, San Bernardino County, within the NW 1/4 of Section 31, T14N, R9E, SBB&M, as shown on attachment "A," which is made part of this Order.

6. Description of Facility and Discharge

The Facility is made up of four evaporation/percolation ponds at a size of approximately two and one half acres each, and one new five-acre evaporation/percolation pond. These ponds use algal and bacterial action to treat the sewage with both aerobic and anaerobic processes. The wastewater is allowed to infiltrate into the soil beneath the ponds and is evaporated. The Facility has a design capacity of 0.35 mgd during the winter months and 0.52 mgd during the summer months. The greater summer wastewater disposal capacity is due to more favorable weather conditions for wastewater treatment. The current wastewater flow to the ponds ranges from 0.23 mgd in the winter to 0.29 mgd in the summer.

7. Authorized Disposal Sites

The five evaporation/percolation ponds are the only authorized disposal sites for wastewater. The authorized disposal sites are located on land owned and operated by the Discharger.

8. Sludge Disposal

The Facility produces very little sludge. Sludge accumulates at the bottom of the evaporation/percolation ponds. During cleaning of the ponds, sludge is mixed with dirt and used for reinforcement of the pond dikes. There is no off site disposal of sludge.

9. Site Geology

The Facility is located on the northern edge of Soda Dry Lake at an elevation of about 950 feet. Soils in the dry lake are fine textured, ranging from very fine sandy loam to silty clay loam. The soils are saline and drainage ranges from well to poorly drained.

10. Site Hydrology

No perennial streams exist in the vicinity of the Facility. However, during periods of heavy rain the flow of the Mojave River sometimes reaches Soda Dry Lake. These occasions are rare and the evaporation/percolation ponds are located well above any potential surface water flow.

11. Site Hydrogeology

Ground water in the vicinity of the Facility is at a depth of approximately 100 feet with a ground water gradient toward Soda Dry Lake. The ground water is high in total dissolved solids with concentrations ranging from 1,000 ppm 0.5 miles upgradient from the Facility to 5,000 ppm in the immediate vicinity of the Facility. The drinking water wells for the community of Baker are located two miles upgradient from the Facility and provide good quality drinking water.

12. Receiving Waters

The receiving waters are the ground waters of the Soda Lake Valley Ground Water Basin (Department of Water Resources Ground Water Basin No. 6-33).

13. Lahontan Basin Plan

The Regional Board adopted the Water Quality Control Plan for the Lahontan Basin (Basin Plan) which became effective on March 31, 1995, and this Order implements the Basin Plan as amended.

14. Beneficial Uses

The beneficial uses of the ground waters of the Soda Lake Valley Ground Water Basin as set forth and defined in the Basin Plan are:

- a. municipal and domestic supply
- b. agricultural supply
- c. industrial service supply
- d. freshwater replenishment

15. California Environmental Quality Act Compliance

These WDRs govern an existing Facility which the Discharger is currently operating. The project consists only of the continued operation of the existing Facility and is therefore exempt from the provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act (Public Resources Code, Section 21000 et seq.) in accordance with Section 15301, Chapter 3, Title 14 of the California Code of Regulations.

16. Notification of Interested Parties

The Regional Board has notified the Discharger and interested parties of its intent to revise WDRs for the discharge.

17. Consideration of Public Comments

The Regional Board, in a public meeting, heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that the Discharger shall comply with the following:

I. DISCHARGE SPECIFICATIONS

A. Effluent/Discharge Limitations

1. The total effluent flow of wastewater during a 24-hour period shall not exceed 0.35 million gallons from November through March of each year and shall not exceed 0.52 million gallons from April through October of each year.
2. All wastewater made available for percolation at the authorized disposal sites shall have a pH of not less than 6.0 pH units nor more than 9.0 pH units. A pH over 9.0 is allowed if it results from a biological process in the Facility.
3. All wastewater made available for percolation at the authorized disposal sites shall have a dissolved oxygen concentration of not less than 1.0 mg/l.

B. Receiving Water Limitations

The discharge of waste shall not cause the presence of the following substances or conditions in ground waters of the Soda Lake Valley Ground Water Basin:

1. any perceptible color, odor, taste or foaming;
2. coliform organisms attributable to human wastes;
3. toxic substances in concentrations that individually, collectively, or cumulatively cause detrimental physiological responses in human, plants, animals, or aquatic life;
4. identifiable chlorinated hydrocarbons, organophosphates, carbamates, and other pesticide and herbicide groups, in summations, in excess of the lowest detectable levels; and
5. concentrations of chemical constituents in excess of the maximum contaminant levels or secondary maximum contaminant levels based upon drinking water standards specified by the more restrictive of the California Code of Regulations, Title 22, Division 4, Chapter 15, or 40 CFR, Part 141.

C. General Requirements and Prohibitions

1. There shall be no discharge, bypass, or diversion of raw or partially treated sewage, sewage sludge, grease, or oils from the collection, transport, or disposal facilities to adjacent land areas or surface waters.

2. Surface flow or visible discharge of sewage or sewage effluent from the authorized disposal sites to adjacent land areas or surface waters is prohibited.
3. The vertical distance between the liquid surface elevation and the lowest point of a pond dike or the invert of an overflow structure shall not be less than two feet.
4. The discharge shall not cause a pollution as defined in Section 13050 of the California Water Code, or a threatened pollution.
5. Neither the treatment nor the discharge shall cause a nuisance as defined in Section 13050 of the California Water Code.
6. The discharge of wastewater except to the authorized disposal sites is prohibited.
7. The Discharger shall comply with all existing state laws and regulations that apply to sewage sludge use and disposal practices.

II. PROVISIONS

A. Rescission of WDRs

Board Order No. 6-94-101 is hereby rescinded.

B. Operator Certification

The Discharger's Facility shall be supervised by persons possessing a wastewater treatment facility operator certificate of appropriate grade pursuant to Chapter 26, Title 23, California Code of Regulations.

C. Standard Provisions

The Discharger shall comply with the "Standard Provisions for Waste Discharge Requirements," dated September 1, 1994, in Attachment "B", which is made part of this Order.

D. Monitoring and Reporting

1. Pursuant to the California Water Code Section 13267(b), the Discharger shall comply with Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 97-95 as specified by the Executive Officer.

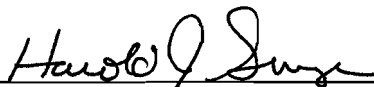
BAKER COMMUNITY SERVICES
DISTRICT WASTEWATER
TREATMENT FACILITY
San Bernardino County

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BOARD ORDER NO. 6-97-95
WDID NO. 6B360100001

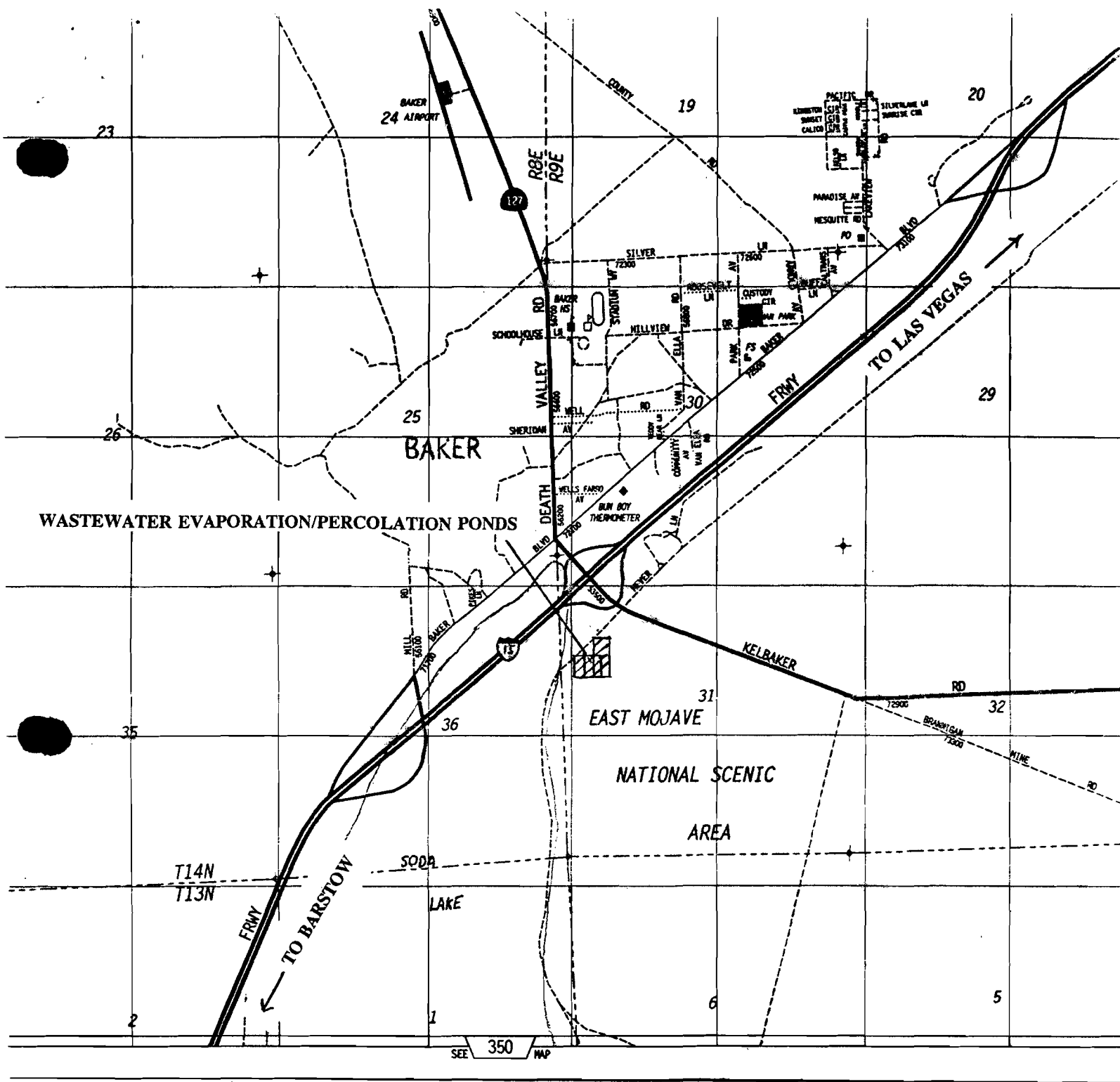
2. The Discharger shall comply with the "General Provisions for Monitoring and Reporting," dated September 1, 1994, which is attached to and made part of the Monitoring and Reporting Program.

I, Harold J. Singer, Executive Officer, do hereby certify that the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an Order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Lahontan Region, on October 8, 1997.



HAROLD J. SINGER
EXECUTIVE OFFICER

Attachments: A. Location Map
B. Standard Provisions for Waste Discharge Requirements



ATTACHMENT "A"

BAKER COMMUNITY SERVICES DISTRICT WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY

Intersection of Kelbaker Road and Interstate 15
Baker, California

COUNTY OF SAN BERNARDINO

NW 1/4, Section 31, T14N, R9E, SBB&M

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD

STANDARD PROVISIONS **FOR WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS**

1. Inspection and Entry

The Discharger shall permit Regional Board staff:

- a. to enter upon premises in which an effluent source is located or in which any required records are kept;
- b. to copy any records relating to the discharge or relating to compliance with the Waste Discharge Requirements;
- c. to inspect monitoring equipment or records; and
- d. to sample any discharge.

2. Reporting Requirements

- a. Pursuant to California Water Code 13267(b), the Discharger shall immediately notify the Regional Board by telephone whenever an adverse condition occurred as a result of this discharge; written confirmation shall follow within two weeks. An adverse condition includes, but is not limited to, spills of petroleum products or toxic chemicals, or damage to control facilities that could affect compliance.
- b. Pursuant to California Water Code Section 13260(c), any proposed material change in the character of the waste, manner or method of treatment or disposal, increase of discharge, or location of discharge, shall be reported to the Regional Board at least 120 days in advance of implementation of any such proposal. This shall include, but not limited to, all significant soil disturbances.
- c. The Owners/Discharger of property subject to Waste Discharge Requirements shall be considered to have a continuing responsibility for ensuring compliance with applicable Waste Discharge Requirements in the operations or use of the owned property. Pursuant to California Water Code Section 13260(c), any change in the ownership and/or operation of property subject to the Waste Discharge Requirements shall be reported to the Regional Board. Notification of applicable Waste Discharge Requirements shall be furnished in writing to the new owners and/or operators and a copy of such notification shall be sent to the Regional Board.
- d. If a Discharger becomes aware that any information submitted to the Regional Board is incorrect, the Discharger shall immediately notify the Regional Board, in writing and correct that information.
- e. Reports required by the Waste Discharge Requirements, and other information requested by the Regional Board, must be signed by a duly authorized representative of the Discharger. Under Section 13268 of the California Water Code, any person failing or refusing to furnish technical or monitoring reports, or falsifying any information provided therein, is guilty of a misdemeanor and may be liable civilly in an amount of up to one thousand dollars (\$1,000) for each day of violation.

10. Availability

A copy of the Waste Discharge Requirements shall be kept and maintained by the Discharger and be available at all times to operating personnel.

11. Severability

Provisions of the Waste Discharge Requirements are severable. If any provision of the requirements is found invalid, the remainder of the requirements shall not be affected.

12. Public Access

General public access shall be effectively excluded from disposal/treatment facilities.

13. Transfers

Providing there is no material change in the operation of the facility, this Order may be transferred to a new owner or operator. The owner/operator must request the transfer in writing and receive written approval from the Regional Board's Executive Officer.

14. Definitions

- a. "Surface waters" as used in this Order, include, but are not limited to, live streams, either perennial or ephemeral, which flow in natural or artificial water courses and natural lakes and artificial impoundments of waters. "Surface waters" does not include artificial water courses or impoundments used exclusively for wastewater disposal.
- b. "Ground waters" as used in this Order, include, but are not limited to, all subsurface waters being above atmospheric pressure and the capillary fringe of these waters.

15. Storm Protection

- a. All facilities used for collection, transport, treatment, storage, or disposal of waste shall be adequately protected against overflow, washout, inundation, structural damage or a significant reduction in efficiency resulting from a storm or flood having a recurrence interval of once in 100 years.

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
LAHONTAN REGION

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. 97-95
WDID NO. 6B360100001

FOR

**BAKER COMMUNITY SERVICES DISTRICT
WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY**

San Bernardino County

I. MONITORING

A. Flow Monitoring

The Discharger shall monitor the following:

1. The total volume, in million gallons, of wastewater flow to the Facility for each day.
2. The total volume, in million gallons, of wastewater flow to the Facility for each month.
3. The average flow rate, in million gallons per day, of wastewater to the Facility calculated for each month.
4. The freeboard (distance from the top of the lowest part of the dike to the wastewater surface in the pond) measured each month in each evaporation/percolation pond. If a pond does not contain wastewater, indicate that it is empty.

B. Facility Effluent Monitoring

1. Grab samples of the domestic wastewater to the sewage lagoon ponds shall be collected and analyzed annually to determine the magnitude of the following parameters:

<u>Parameter</u>	<u>Units</u>
Biochemical Oxygen Demand	mg/l
pH	pH units
Oil & Grease	mg/l
Dissolved Oxygen	mg/l
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/l

C. Sludge Monitoring

The Discharger shall submit a Sludge Management Plan (Plan) 90 days prior to any planned pond cleaning operation. The Plan shall outline actions necessary for the Discharger to be in compliance with all state laws and regulations. Copies of reports submitted to other agencies regarding sludge disposal operations shall be included in the Plan.

II. REPORTING

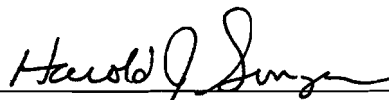
A. General Provisions

The Discharger shall comply with the "General Provisions for Monitoring and Reporting," dated September 1, 1994, which is attached to and made part of this Monitoring and Reporting Program.

B. Submittal Periods

Beginning on **January 30, 1998** an annual monitoring report including the preceding information shall be submitted to the Regional Board. Samples must be collected sufficiently in advance to ensure that lab analysis and report will be available for a timely submittal.

Ordered by:


HAROLD J. SINGER
EXECUTIVE OFFICER

Dated: October 8, 1997

Attachment: General Provisions for Monitoring and Reporting

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
LAHONTAN REGION

GENERAL PROVISIONS
FOR MONITORING AND REPORTING

1. SAMPLING AND ANALYSIS

- a. All analyses shall be performed in accordance with the current edition(s) of the following documents:
 - i. Standard Methods for the Examination of Water and Wastewater
 - ii. Methods for Chemical Analysis of Water and Wastes, EPA
- b. All analyses shall be performed in a laboratory certified to perform such analyses by the California State Department of Health Services or a laboratory approved by the Regional Board. Specific methods of analysis must be identified on each laboratory report.
- c. Any modifications to the above methods to eliminate known interferences shall be reported with the sample results. The method used shall also be reported. If methods other than USEPA approved methods or Standard Methods are used, the exact methodology must be submitted for review and must be approved by the Regional Board prior to use.
- d. The Discharger shall establish chain-of-custody procedures to ensure that specific individuals are responsible for sample integrity from commencement of sample collection through delivery to an approved laboratory. Sample collection, storage and analysis shall be conducted in accordance with an approved Sampling and Analysis Plan (SAP). The most recent version of the approved SAP shall be kept at the facility.
- e. The Discharger shall calibrate and perform maintenance procedures on all monitoring instruments and equipment to ensure accuracy of measurements, or shall ensure that both activities will be conducted. The calibration of any wastewater flow measuring device shall be recorded and maintained in the permanent log book described in 2.b, below.
- f. A grab sample is defined as an individual sample collected in fewer than 15 minutes.
- g. A composite sample is defined as a combination of no fewer than eight individual samples obtained over the specified sampling period at equal intervals. The volume of each individual sample shall be proportional to the discharge flow rate at the time of sampling. The sampling period shall equal the discharge period, or 24 hours, whichever period is shorter.

- iii. In the case of a sole proprietorship, by the proprietor;
 - iv. In the case of a municipal, state or other public facility, by either a principal executive officer, ranking elected official, or other duly authorized employee.
- e. Monitoring reports are to include the following:
- i. Name and telephone number of individual who can answer questions about the report.
 - ii. The Monitoring and Reporting Program Number.
 - iii. WDID Number.
- f. Modifications

This Monitoring and Reporting Program may be modified at the discretion of the Regional Board Executive Officer.

4. NONCOMPLIANCE

Under Section 13268 of the Water Code, any person failing or refusing to furnish technical or monitoring reports or falsifying any information provided therein, is guilty of a misdemeanor and may be liable civilly in an amount of up to one thousand dollars (\$1,000) for each day of violation under Section 13268 of the Water Code.